

GDC Production Manager

Complete guide: installation, features explained, examples, troubleshooting

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Guide updated for app version 1.1.2

1. What is GDC Production Manager

GDC Production Manager is a standalone desktop app for managing video production projects — films, commercials, weddings, documentaries, broadcast, music videos, corporate. Each user installs it on their own laptop; data stays 100% local, nothing leaves your machine without your say-so.

Technically, the app starts a local server (Flask + SQLite) and automatically opens the interface in a browser tab, at an address like `http://127.0.0.1:xxxx` — it looks and works like a website, but runs entirely on your computer, with no online account and no mandatory cloud.

What it can do

- Track projects through every stage: planning → filming → editing → coloring → review → final → delivered.
- Keep records of clients, 1-on-1 courses, and digital products (DCTLs, LUTs, presets) you sell.
- Reusable per-project checklists, reminders for deadlines and invoices, a monthly calendar.
- PDF reports, JSON export/import for backup, light/dark theme.
- A built-in Help page inside the app, covering everything it can do — no need to search online.
- Full interface in Romanian, English and Spanish.

What it does NOT do

- It's not a remote multi-user cloud system — syncing between laptops is optional and self-hosted, not through a third-party server.
- It doesn't issue official tax invoices — billing in the app is simple, for your own record-keeping (budget, amount received, status).
- No Linux version yet — Mac and Windows only.

Note: The source code is open (MIT license), fully available on GitHub. The compiled, distributed app has a 7-day free trial, then requires activation — see section 7 for details.

2. Installation

- macOS** Download GDCProductionManager-mac.zip from the Releases page, unzip it, then double-click the .pkg file and follow the standard macOS installer steps.
- Windows** Download GDCProductionManager-windows.zip from the Releases page, unzip it, then double-click the .exe to run it directly — no separate installation needed.

First run

The app automatically opens the interface in a new browser tab, at a local address (<http://127.0.0.1:xxxx>). If the browser doesn't open automatically, check the address shown in the app window and copy it manually into a browser. The first step is creating a local account — you'll get a recovery code shown once (see section 4).

Note: Each archive (.zip) also includes this PDF guide, in all 3 languages — no need to download it separately.

3. Features, explained in detail

Projects & stages

Every project has a type (film, commercial, wedding, documentary, broadcast, music video, corporate), a shoot location, and shoot/delivery dates. The stages are fixed: planning → filming → editing → coloring → review → final → delivered. The “Next Step” button advances the project automatically, with a visual progress bar. Every stage keeps its own separate note field.

Clients

Contact details and how many projects/courses each client has.

1-on-1 courses

Each course has a topic, date/time, duration, price, payment status, course status (scheduled/confirmed/completed/cancelled), and location (online/in person) — linked to a client.

Digital products

DCTLs, PowerGrades, LUTs, presets or templates: price, version, compatibility, local path and download link.

Selectable currency (EUR / RON)

Every project, course or product can have its own currency. Dashboard totals are calculated SEPARATELY per currency — never mixed.

Checklists & templates

A template is a reusable list of items, created once from Settings → Checklists (name, type - pre-shoot/post-shoot/general, an optional project type, and the items, one per line). On any project, in the Checklists field, pick the template from a menu and click “+ New checklist” — the items appear automatically, ready to check off, with a progress bar. A project can have several checklists. 4 templates come built in (Pre-shoot Wedding, Post-shoot Wedding, Pre-shoot Commercial, Post-shoot Commercial), fully editable or deletable — you can create as many more as you like. Editing a template doesn't change checklists already created from it, only future ones.

Reminders & notifications

Reminders for deadlines, unpaid invoices, or meetings, with a dashboard summary. In-app notifications plus native browser notifications (if you grant the permission).

Calendar & .ics export

A monthly calendar of shoots and deliveries, exportable as an .ics file to Apple Calendar, Outlook or Google Calendar.

PDF reports

Per-project and per-checklist reports, printable straight from the app.

Backup: Export / Import JSON

From Settings, export all your data to a JSON file — use it as a periodic backup or to move data to another laptop.

Optional self-hosted sync

Link two installs of the app, usually on the same local network, to sync data, with no third-party server.

Local multi-user

Several accounts can exist on the same laptop, each with fully separate data.

In-app update checker

From Settings, a “Check for updates” button tells you if a newer version is available and takes you straight to the

download.

4. Account & security

Recovery code

At registration you get a recovery code shown once (like XXXX-XXXX-XXXX-XXXX) — save it somewhere safe. It's the only way to reset your password if you forget it, since the app has no email and sends nothing over the internet. Use the “Forgot your password?” link on the login screen. After a successful reset, you get a new code (the old one stops working). You can regenerate it anytime from Settings, with your current password.

Touch ID / Windows Hello

From Settings, you can enable a quick fingerprint (Mac) or Windows Hello login, on this computer. Your password always stays available as a fallback — Touch ID is optional, never mandatory.

Multiple local accounts

Several people can use the same install, each with a fully separate account and data, on the same computer.

5. Practical usage examples

A new project from scratch

- Add new project → choose the type (e.g. wedding) → fill in client, shoot/delivery dates, currency.
- Apply the “Pre-shoot Wedding” checklist template — comes pre-filled with standard items.
- As you go, click “Next Step” for each finished stage.
- At the end, generate the PDF report and hand it to the client.

Backup before a new laptop

- Settings → Export JSON — save the file somewhere safe (personal cloud, USB).
- On the new laptop, install the app, then Settings → Import JSON.
- All projects, clients, courses and products come back exactly as they were.

I forgot my password

- On the login screen, click “Forgot your password?”
- Enter your username and the recovery code you got at registration.
- Choose a new password — you immediately get a new recovery code to save.

6. Common issues & solutions

Browser doesn't open automatically

Check the app window — the local address (`http://127.0.0.1:xxxx`) is shown there. Copy it manually into a browser.

Lost data after reinstalling

Data is local, in a SQLite database. Do periodic JSON exports from Settings, especially before a major reinstall or a new laptop.

I forgot my password AND my recovery code

Unfortunately, without the recovery code, the local account can't be recovered automatically — the app has no email or server. Contact me directly if you need help.

Dashboard totals look off

They're calculated separately for EUR and RON, not mixed — check if you have projects in both currencies.

Sync between two laptops isn't working

Requires both installs to be able to communicate directly, usually on the same local network.

7. License & activation

GDC Production Manager has a 7-day full trial, with no limitations — you can test absolutely everything. After that, the app requires a lifetime activation: 25€, one time, no subscription, no renewals.

You activate from Settings → License (or from the activation screen, if the trial has expired) — whenever you want, not only once it expires. There you'll find your computer's ID and a WhatsApp purchase button: you send the ID, get the serial code back manually, enter it, and you're done. The code is locked to that computer — it won't work on another.

Note: The source code stays open (MIT license) on GitHub — you're paying for the activation of the compiled, ready-to-use app, not for the code itself.